

Solar manufacturers' association formed

More than twenty companies from India associated with solar manufacturing have come together to form the Indian Solar (PV) Manufacturers' Association. The association will present together the challenges being faced by the manufacturers and suggest solutions for the growth of the industry in India.

New solar policy for Bengal

The newly-elected West Bengal government will soon bring a policy on solar energy for the state. "The state does not have a policy yet but we are in the process of formulating a suitable policy for the state, which will be declared after Durga Puja," said Manish Gupta, development, planning and power minister.

India launches world's cheapest tablet

India has launched the world's cheapest tablet computing device. Branded as Aakash Low Cost Access Device (LCAD), the \$35 tablet has been designed for higher education. The device was unveiled by human resource development minister Kapil Sibal.

Kontron enters embedded ARM architecture

Kontron has made strategic entry into ARM architecture, enabling a new breed of embedded scalable building blocks for application-ready platforms with low power consumption. The first products planned will be in the module and board form factors. Following the initial release, Kontron plans to expand its single-board computer family, as well as tablets, box PCs and human-machine interfaces.

Karbons plans to invest Rs 1500 million in India

Mobile phone company Karbons will invest Rs 1500 million in India, in the areas of product development, after-sales service centres after-sales service centre and overall marketing. "Karbons is going to set up a 1000-strong after-sales service centre network in upcountry locations with at least one centre in a radius of 150 kilometres and collection point in a radius of 60 kilometres," said Shashin Devsare, executive director, Karbons Mobiles.

HP joins hands with MTS and Intel

HP India has announced a strategic marketing agreement with MTS and Intel to launch a series of activities targeted at the Indian youth. The initiative encourages youngsters to use Intel processors-powered HP notebooks using the MTS MBlast accelerator kit.

Digi-Key and LS Research sign global distribution agreement

Electronic components distributor Digi-Key Corporation and LS Research have signed a global distribution agreement. Mark Zack, vice president of semiconductors, Digi-Key said, "We are pleased to sign this worldwide agreement. With the company's deep history and unmatched experience in wireless product design, LS Research can offer our customers the best in radio module and gateway solutions."

TN farmers get mobile payment system

Farmers in Tamil Nadu can now avail a cashless mobile payment system called Kisan Card. The service, launched by Pallavan Grama Bank, helps the farmers pay their input providers.

"This is the first time that a mobile banking initiative has been made specifically in the agricultural arena. The system is meant to bring down the cost of making transactions, and it works 24x7. It can be extended across the country at any time," said K.C. Chakrabarty, deputy governor,

Reserve Bank of India.

TÜV Rheinland expands its facility in India

TÜV Rheinland has launched India's first 10-metre anechoic chamber at Electronic City in Bengaluru. This chamber will support testing and certification activities for all industry segments including medical, wireless, automotive, electrical and electronics.

The anechoic chamber will enable testing of any electronic and wireless product for its radiations ranging between 9 kHz and 40 GHz in accordance with national and international standards. It will support technologies like Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, Zigbee, 3G and 4G.

"TÜV Rheinland will continuously invest to expand its testing capabilities across India. The investment includes expanding our existing facilities in Bengaluru and New Delhi along with the setting up of new facilities," said Dr Manfred Bayerlein, CEO, TÜV Rheinland.

ARM partners with Open-Silicon

ARM and Open-Silicon, Inc. have signed a comprehensive multi-year licensing agreement for a broad portfolio of ARM technology. This includes ARM Cortex processors and associated ARM processor optimisation packs, ARM Mali graphics processing units and ARM system IP.

The agreement enables Open Silicon to offer customers a one-stop-shop where access to the latest ARM technology is complemented by the provision of system-on-chip design, hardening, prototyping, software development and manufacturing services. Open-Silicon will use ARM technology to provide complete design and development services for low-power chip solutions focusing on the networking, telecommunications, storage and computing markets.